

Your teen will probably need some coaxing and coaching, so walk them through these steps.

Step 1: Whet their appetite

The average household is paying thousands of dollars in ‘lazy tax’.

Which means nothing to your teen . . . until you give them a good reason to get interested: you’ll pay them a commission for every dollar they can save you!

You could decide to split the bounty down the middle—so if they can save you \$500 a year on your power bill (the average saving if you switch, according to the Australian Energy Market Commission), they’ll earn \$250.

Put that in terms that your teen can understand: they could earn more in half an hour of searching on Google than they could in a month of flipping burgers.

How’s that for motivation?

Step 2: Print out your bill

Circle your account number, the bill amount and the time period. Then write down how long you’ve been a loyal customer (guesstimate if you have to).

Step 3: Get them to do some quick research

Give the bill to your teen and have them do a quick search online to find a cheaper deal.

I’d start with your electricity bill, because there can be some good savings there.

Can you switch your electricity retailer?